SAF Architecture Framework

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The chapters 1

This is the full Statistical Architecture Framework document, split into chapters. It is the reference: everything the workgroup has agreed about how a statistical office can describe its production architecture. You do not need to read it in order, and most readers never read all of it.

If you are new to SAF, start with SAF in Brief instead, then come back here for the chapter you need. Terms are explained in the Glossary.

The whole framework is also available as a single complete PDF; see all Downloads.

About this document

Version 0.9. Prepared by the SAF workgroup: Trygve Falch (Statistics Norway, SSB), Jakob Engdahl (Statistics Sweden, SCB), Cedric Couralet (Statistics France, Insee), Pascal Fransen (Statistics Netherlands, CBS) and Daan Swinkels (Statistics Netherlands, CBS). Created 07-07-2025.

Version	Date	Change
0.1	2025-07-07	Initial version
0.2	2026-06-01	Review processed
0.3	2026-07-31	Restructuring, Start with Business Architecture
0.4	2026-09-01	Merging Business Architecture content
0.5	2026-10-10	Restructured motivation section, TOGAF and ArchiMate context added
0.6	2026-10-11	Restructured strategy section
0.7	2026-10-12	Restructured business section, added business actors, roles and collaborations
0.8	2026-10-31	Consolidated and structured Steady State detail content
0.9	2026-11-08	Updated Value stream 1

A few sections are still marked as not yet written. That is deliberate — the framework is a living document.

The chapters

The foundations — why SAF exists and what it is built on.

Chapter	What it covers	Who needs it
Introduction and Scope	What SAF is for, what it covers and what it deliberately does not prescribe, and who it is written for	Everyone, first
Motivation	The pressures driving change, the goals, the eleven architecture principles, the outcomes and the stakeholders	Managers, policy makers, privacy officers
Strategy	The capability model (what an office must be able to do) and the ten value streams	Architects, planners

The business architecture — how the production chain actually works. This is the part most readers come for.

Chapter	What it covers	Who needs it
Business Architecture	Business actors and roles, business processes and functions, and the reference models for the statistical data value chain	Architects, process owners
Steady-State Architecture	The steady states of data, from Raw to Released: definition, quality gate, ownership, security and reuse of each	Everyone working with production
Statistical Data Value Chain	The chain at a glance, the four process types, how each value stream is described, and how the principles apply across the chain	Everyone working with production

The ten value streams in depth — one chapter each. Each follows the same shape: purpose, position and state transition, stages, the four process types, actors and roles, capabilities, principles, interfaces and events, key performance indicators, and the toolkit.

The six production streams, in the order data passes through them:

Chapter	Takes data from → to
VS-01 Data Acquisition and Ingestion	Source data → #1 Raw
VS-02 Data Standardization and Integration	#1 Raw → #2 Standardized
VS-03 Data Editing and Enrichment	#2 Standardized → #3 Processed
VS-04 Estimation, Analysis, and Statistical Modeling	#3 Processed → #4 Statistics
VS-05 Statistical Product Composition	Within #4, to an approved product
VS-06 Dissemination and Service Delivery	#4 → #5 Released → #6 Consumed

The four supporting streams, which run continuously across the whole chain:

Chapter	What it provides
VS-07 Governance and Compliance	Frameworks, controls and assurance
VS-08 Innovation and Methodological Development	Validated new methods and tools
VS-09 Infrastructure and Platform Enablement	Platforms, environments, integration
VS-10 Customer and Stakeholder Engagement	Understood user needs and relationships